ACM IMX Bidding Guidelines

The ACM International Conference on Interactive Media Experiences (ACM IMX) is the leading international conference for presentation and discussion of research into interactive media experiences. The conference brings together international researchers and practitioners from a wide range of disciplines, ranging from human-computer interaction, multimedia engineering and design to media studies, media psychology and sociology. You can find our latest conference at http://imx.acm.org/

A. Aim

The aim of this document is to provide guidelines for the bidding process of organizations interested in hosting the ACM IMX conference in the future.

B. Eligibility - rules

Bids are welcome from any organisation or group thereof as long they are led by researchers with proven research record related to the conference's research topics. The bidders agree to accept:

- the Steering Committee guidelines on publication, refereeing and finances,
- that dates and organisational issues will be agreed with the Steering Committee through negotiation after bidding, and
- the ACM rules including publication of the proceedings in the ACM DL.

C. Bidding Process and Document

Candidates for hosting an ACM IMX conference should prepare a proposal including the major aspects of the conference as described below and submit it to the ACM IMX Steering Committee (tvx@acm.org) by the deadline defined in the invitation letter.

The Steering Committee will evaluate the bids to select the host of the next ACM IMX conference and inform the bidders about the final decision within the deadline specified in the call.

The successful candidate is subject to approval by ACM, based on the submission of the Technical Meeting Request Form (TMRF). Bidders are advised to go through the TMRF guidelines[1] before submitting their original bid to the steering committee.

D. The proposal

The proposal should cover the following points:

1. Geographic location

What is the location (city and region), its flight connections and cultural/special/ACM IMX-related aspects. The location should be easy to travel to, have the potential to attract industry, and be different from the previous year.

1 http://www.acm.org/sigs/volunteer_resources/conference_manual/1-2-1guide

2. Accommodation and flight prices

How much would a participant typically have to pay for a night's accommodation in the area? What are typical flight prices? The location should have varied price options for accommodation.

3. Host name and details

Is the conference going to be co-organized by different institutions? Provide name(s), website(s), history and academic disciplines for each.

4. Host current related research

What are relevant projects, publications, and topics of the host institution(s)?

5. Host experience in conference organization

Please detail number, type and websites of past conferences or international workshops. An ACM IMX host should have a track record of organizing conferences or international workshops and attracting sponsors.

6. Proposed dates and conference theme

Which dates can the ACM IMX conference be held (three days, usually around end of June)? What is the general conference theme? The planned dates must provide enough time (from submission to decision) to hold a TPC meeting and to offer authors a rebuttal option and should be consistent with previous years.

7. Proposed organizing committee

Names of local and international committee members, the latter with a mix of experienced committee members and new members. Please take a look at the organizing committees of the last conference: https://imx.acm.org/sc/conference-series/

Please include a short CV (max half a page) of the intended program chair(s), conference chair(s) and local organization committee chairs. The committee (OC and PC) must be diverse (international, interdisciplinary, age, gender, experience, background: industry/academia).

8. Conference venue(s)

Which rooms are available and how many participants can they hold? Will workshops and courses be held at the same location as the main conference (multiple smaller rooms are needed)? Is there a larger room available for the plenary session (around 200 participants) as well as two or three rooms for the parallel sessions at the main conference? Is there a suitable room available for demos and posters? The venue should already be decided and must include space for demonstration sessions and exhibitions.

If you have two options, then we will expect to see enough details (inc. cost) of both options in order to make a decision.

9. Draft budget

Provide drafts of conference registration costs (for regular participants and students, ACM members and non-members), workshops and courses, possible sponsorship deals, costs of venue, catering, etc. including fixed and variable costs as required by the rules of ACM. The budget must be realistic and cover the most important parts (venue, social events, student support). It should be complete and have a good balance.

10. Student support

Is there a foreseen mechanism for increasing the number of (PhD) students attending the conference (e.g. student grants)? The budget should have reduced prices for students and doctoral consortium participants but include the social events.

11. Sponsors

Which sponsors are likely and how will you attract sponsorship? You should present a clear sponsor ship plan if not a list of specific sponsors.

E. Evaluation criteria

Bids will be evaluated according to the following criteria on five dimensions: location, venue, dates, organizers, and budget. Compulsory criteria are in bold and bids should be amended or else will be rejected if they are not fulfilled.

Location

- should have potential to attract industry
- should have a varied range (mainly price) of hotels
- should be different from year to year (possibly even the continent)
- should be easy to travel to

Venue

- should be already decided
- should have remote participation options (updated addition in response to the pandemic)
- **must include space for demonstration sessions and exhibitions**

Dates

- **must provide enough time (from submission to decision) to hold a TPC meeting and to offer authors a rebuttal option**
- should be consistent with previous years

Organizers

- **OC/PC must be diverse (international, interdisciplinary, age, gender, experience, industry/academia mix)**
- host organization should have a good reputation
- should have a track record of organizing conferences
- should have a track record of attracting sponsors.

Budget

- **must be realistic and cover the most important things (venue, social events, student support)**
- should have a good balance and be complete
- should have reduced prices for students and DC participants, including social events
- should include a sponsorship plan

Process of winning the bid is by vote on the steering committee after the extensive evaluative process including a discussion of merits.